

Microsoft and Google's staggering water consumption rates for AI

Posted by u/Alsupercharged • 0 points • 11 comments

AI, with its vast resource needs, is raising concerns over sustainability and environmental impact. Last year, Microsoft's data centers drained over 2,500 Olympic-sized swimming pools worth of water, reflecting a 34% increase from the previous year. Google also reported a 20% water consumption increase over the same period.

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****A deeper look at AI's water footprint****

- The growth of AI and related technologies increases the need for vast server farms, which depend heavily on water for cooling purposes.
- The spike in water usage can be attributed primarily to AI, as per Shaolei Ren, a researcher at the UC, Riverside, who focuses on AI's environmental impact.
- For every 5 to 50 prompts submitted to ChatGPT, it consumes about 500 ml of water, according to an upcoming paper from Professor Ren's team.

****Big Tech and responsible water usage****

- Recognizing their significant water consumption, tech companies like Google have voiced concerns and are exploring ways to mitigate the negative effects.
- Google has committed to responsible water usage, which includes assessing where and how their water usage might affect surrounding areas.

[(source)](<https://www.independent.co.uk/tech/ai-water-energy-artificial-intelligence-b2409356.html>)

****P.S.** If you like this kind of analysis, ****** I write [a free newsletter](https://supercharged-ai.beehiiv.com/subscribe?utm_source=reddit&utm_medium=ai-water&utm_campaign=campaign) that explores the latest AI developments. Professionals from Google, Meta, and OpenAI are already reading it.

Comments

u/Mesmoiron • 1 points • 2023-09-12 18:21 UTC

That's a good problem to solve with innovation. It is telling that such tech giants, haven't looked into it and solved that.

u/Responsible_Rain_438 • 1 points • 2023-09-12 16:35 UTC

They should ask Ai to give them a solution. They should threaten it with termination if it doesn't come up with a good solution 🤡🤡

u/spacecam • 1 points • 2023-09-12 14:30 UTC

Nearly everything on the internet uses these same techniques to cool their servers. The idea that chat gpt specifically is the problem is absurd. This is targeted fud.

u/West-Cod-6576 • 1 points • 2023-09-12 13:14 UTC

Thats why you just build the server farm on a boat or oil rig or something, infinite water ezpz

u/uselessadjective • 2 points • 2023-09-12 09:39 UTC

Yes, Data centers and big computing server rooms just recircle the same water.

Just like our PC's custom loop cooling but in a more sophisticsted way.

Power consumption rises for sure.

u/ILikeBubblyWater • 9 points • 2023-09-12 06:03 UTC

Does consuming mean they just pump it from somewhere, cool their stuff and pump it back?

Kinda feels like this could be misleading clickbait

u/FlappySocks • 1 points • 2023-09-13 01:43 UTC

Even if they didn't recycle it, I don't see an issue. So long as they are not contaminating the water, or causing an ecological issue.

u/freeman_joe • 2 points • 2023-09-12 10:34 UTC

But but but they used Olympic sized swimming pools as unit of measurement surely it isn't some kind of nonsense click bait article.

u/Fingerspitzengefuhl • 6 points • 2023-09-12 06:32 UTC

Also, does computer-parts-cooling necessarily use drinking water?

u/Tree8282 • 4 points • 2023-09-12 06:29 UTC

Right?? I don't see why they won't reuse the water by pumping it back

u/Sotsvamp1337 • 1 points • 2023-09-12 18:07 UTC

Exactly. Normally consumer PCs with water cooling uses a closed water loop. Why can't this be done on a larger scale for these data centres?

u/AutoModerator • 1 points • 2023-09-12 05:04 UTC

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